A free guide from Elevate STEM

Literature Review Guide

A literature review is just a careful look at what's already been published on your topic. Here's a quick way to do one, with a little help from AI.

1 **Choose your papers**

Pick a few papers that are closely related to your topic. Check that they're trustworthy: who wrote them, what journal they're in, and how recent they are.

2 **Upload one to ChatPDF**

Go to *chatpdf.com* and upload the PDF of one paper. It reads the paper and can answer your questions about it.

3 **Ask questions**

Start by asking for a summary. Then ask about the specifics: key findings, the methods they used, and any gaps or open questions the authors mention. Do this for each paper.

Heads up: *AI summaries sometimes get details wrong, so double-check anything important against the actual paper.*

4 **Use the gaps**

The gaps you found are your opening. Use them to focus your own project, and to explain what your study adds to the field.

— The Elevate STEM team